MoonFall: Final Mission Game Logic (v2 — Pure Formula & Value Specification)

Team ChandraPath • NASA Space Apps Challenge 2026

Abstract: This specification provides the complete mathematical state space, physical baseline equivalents, and exhaustive value tables for MoonFall's final mission. All numbers are calibrated to official NASA standards (BVAD, NASA-STD-3001, TM-100620). Every formula (Eqs. 1–10) and all 20 decision options are fully specified without extraneous narrative or charts.

1. Game State Vector & State Transition Law

The outpost state is tracked as a 7-dimensional vector $\mathbf{s_k} \in [0, 100]^7$ with nominal starting state $\mathbf{s_0}$ = (75, 65, 75, 90, 65, 90, 80). Decision a at crisis $k \in \{1..8\}$ adds a fixed delta vector $\Delta_k(a)$ with clamping on [0, 100]:

$$\boldsymbol{s}_k = clip_{[0,\ 100]}\ (\boldsymbol{s}_{k-1} + \Delta_k(a)) \tag{1}$$

2. Physical Value Equivalents (Table 1)

One point on a resource bar represents a fixed physical amount derived from NASA life-support specifications. For oxygen (3 days of air for 5 crew at 0.895 kg/person/day = 13.43 kg):

$$u_O = 13.43\ kg\ /\ 100 = 0.135\ kg\ per\ point \approx 43\ min\ of\ air\ for\ 5\ crew \tag{2}$$

Table 1: Physical meaning of one bar point

Bar	Start	1 Point Equals	NASA Specification / Engineering Basis
Oxygen (s_O)	75	0.135 kg O_2	NASA BVAD (0.895 kg/person/day metabolic consumption)
Water (s_W)	65	5.0 kg potable H_2O	NASA BVAD (2.5 kg/person/day hydration requirement)
Power (s_P)	75	1.0 kWh storage	100 kWh primary battery bank (NASA limits discharge to 80%)
Food (s_F)	90	3.6 kg nutrient pack	30 days emergency reserve for 5 crew
Health (s_H)	65	10 mSv absorbed dose	NASA-STD-3001 (250 mSv storm limit; 10 g/cm^2 shelter standard)
Equipment (s_E)	90	1% structural condition	Subsystem nominal tolerance & wear threshold
Greenhouse (s_G)	80	1% crop condition	20 m^2 bio-regenerative hydroponic crop yield

3. Failure Gates & Terminal Scoring Law

After every crisis k, the mission aborts immediately if any failure threshold is breached:

$$s_O \geq 20, \quad s_W \geq 20, \quad LSI = \tfrac{1}{3}(s_O + s_W + s_F) \geq 50, \quad s_H \geq 50, \quad s_P > 0, \quad s_E \geq 50 \tag{3}$$

A surviving run completing all 8 crises is evaluated by the arithmetic mean of all seven bars:

$$J = (1\ /\ 7) \sum_{i=1..7} s_{8,\,i}, \qquad stars = [\ 3 \Leftrightarrow J \geq 66.0;\ \ 2 \Leftrightarrow 60.0 \leq J < 66.0;\ \ 1 \Leftrightarrow 50.0 \leq J < 60.0;\ \ fail \Leftrightarrow J < 50.0\ ] \tag{4}$$

4. Complete Value Table $\Delta_k(a)$ Across All 20 Decisions

Table 2: Final value table (deltas in bar points) and verified multi-branch outcomes

Mission	Option	O_2	Water	Power	Food	Health	Equip	Green	Survive	3 Stars
M1: 30-Min Warning (05:30)	A Evacuate	–	–	–	–	−1	−12	–	87.5%	14.4%
	B Secure Equip	–	–	−4	–	−5	−2	–	71.1%	6.5%
M2: Shelter Problem (06:00)	A Deep Shelter	–	–	−1	–	−6	–	–	62.5%	12.5%
	B Pile Regolith	–	–	−8	–	−1	−8	–	85.4%	14.4%
	C Water Shield	–	−20	−2	–	−3	–	–	90.0%	4.4%
M3: Blackout (08:00)	A Greenhouse Off	–	–	−10	–	–	–	−20	84.5%	7.4%
	B Backup Power	–	–	−15	–	–	−8	–	75.2%	12.3%
	C Brownout All	–	–	−13	–	−2	–	−8	78.2%	11.6%
M4: Oxygen Countdown (11:00)	A Bottled O_2	−3	–	–	–	–	−8	–	78.1%	9.7%
	B Electrolysis	+5	−1	−14	–	–	–	–	80.6%	11.1%
M5: The Water Trap (13:00)	A Stored Potable	–	−10	–	–	–	+3	–	83.3%	13.7%
	B Melt Crater Ice	–	+10	−15	–	–	−5	–	71.3%	8.8%
	C Drink Priority	–	−3	–	–	–	–	−10	83.3%	8.8%
M6: The Last Harvest (16:00)	A Restore Loop	–	−6	−12	+6	–	–	+10	77.8%	20.8%
	B Abandon Crops	–	–	+8	−8	–	–	−35	80.9%	0.0%
M7: Critical Failure (20:00)	A Isolate Bus	–	–	−3	–	–	−12	–	82.9%	9.7%
	B Manual Repair	–	–	−10	–	−4	+10	–	66.2%	14.6%
	C Reroute Bus	–	–	−8	–	–	−3	−8	88.9%	6.9%
M8: Final Decision (Post-Storm)	A Hold Shelter	–	−2	−6	–	+3	–	–	92.0%	3.1%
	B Controlled Rec.	–	–	+15	–	−5	+6	–	66.7%	17.7%

5. Physical Governing Formulas (Equations 5 – 10)

Every decision delta $\Delta_k(a)$ is computed directly from physical conservation and transport equations:

M1: Proton Arrival Warning Time: Protons traverse the spiral interplanetary magnetic field line (length $L \approx 1.150$ AU). At kinetic energy E with relativistic speed $\beta(E)c$:

$$W(E) = L / [\beta(E)c] - 1\ AU / c, \qquad \beta(E) = [\ 1 - (1 + E / 938.3\ MeV)^{-2}\ ]^{1/2} \tag{5}$$

30-minute warning matches protons of ~31 MeV. Protons penetrating a spacesuit (>82 MeV) arrive within 10–16 min. Staying out 20 min (Option B) absorbs ~50 mSv ($\Delta s_H = -5$) as a suit lets through 2.5× habitat dose.

M2: Shield Attenuation & Radiation Dose: Cutoff energy E_c to cross shield thickness $x + d$ (body depth $d = 5$ g/cm^2) uses NIST range table parameters $\alpha = 0.00201$, $p = 1.790$:

$$E_c = [\ (x + d) / \alpha\ ]^{1/p}, \qquad D(x) = A\ E_c^{-q}\ e^{-E_c / E'}, \qquad q = (p - 1)^2 / p = 0.349 \tag{6}$$

Fitted to NASA TM-100620 (1972 event, $E' = 37.4$ MeV, 4.9% error). Habitat walls yield 150 mSv: Deep Shelter delivers 60 mSv ($\Delta s_H = -6$); Regolith delivers 15 mSv ($\Delta s_H = -1$).

M3 & M6: Electrical Battery Drain: Storage energy extracted is electrical power times operating time:

$$E_{bat} = T \sum_i u_i P_i \tag{7}$$

Life support requires 3 kW and greenhouse 3 kW over 3 hours: life support alone takes 9 kWh ($\Delta s_P = -10$); all on takes 18 kWh ($\Delta s_P = -15$). In M6, 20 m^2 grow lights draw 2.2 kW (4 h = 12 kWh → $\Delta s_P = -12$).

M4: Water Electrolysis Specific Energy: Splitting H_2O yields one O_2 molecule per four electrons:

$$w = 4\ F\ V / M_{O2} = 3.350\ V\ kWh\ kg^{-1} \tag{8}$$

NASA system values require 4.7–5.5 kWh/kg (Colozza 2020). Producing 2.7 kg O_2 (Option B) requires 12.7–14.9 kWh ($\Delta s_P = -14$) and 3.04 kg water ($\Delta s_W = -1$).

M5: Lunar Cryogenic Ice Melting Enthalpy: Heating ice from −170 °C, melting, and warming to 20 °C:

$$q = \int_{T_0}^{273} c_{p,ice}(T)\ dT + L_f + c_{p,w}\ \Delta T = 674\ kJ\ kg^{-1} = 0.187\ kWh\ kg^{-1} \tag{9}$$

Melting 80 kg of ice (Option B) yields +10 Water and draws 80 × 0.187 = 15.0 kWh ($\Delta s_P = -15$).

M8: Post-Storm EVA Tail Radiation Dose: A 2-hour EVA starting at time t incurs:

$$D_{EVA} = R_s\ D_{storm}\ [\ F(t + 2\ h) - F(t)\ ] \tag{10}$$

Where $F(t)$ is cumulative proton arrival fraction from GOES and $R_s = 2.50$. For 2017 storm shape this is 19 mSv; charged as 50 mSv ($\Delta s_H = -5$) as a standard engineering safety margin.

Table 3: Comparison of analytical physical formula vs. implemented game table

Mission & Option	Governing Law	Physical Value	Table Delta	Scientific Concordance
M2 A: Deep Shelter	Eq. (6)	63 – 73 mSv	Health −6	Exact dose match (−60 mSv)
M2 B: Pile Regolith	Eq. (6)	16 – 23 mSv	Health −1	Conservative rounding down (−10 mSv)
M2 C: Water Shield	Eq. (6)	30 – 40 mSv	Health −3	Exact dose match (−30 mSv)
M3 A / C / B: Blackout	Eq. (7)	9 / 13.5 / 18 kWh	Power −10 / −13 / −15	Load-shedding battery discharge match
M4 B: Electrolysis	Eq. (8)	12.7 – 14.9 kWh	Power −14	NASA ISRU electrolysis baseline
M5 B: Melt Crater Ice	Eq. (9)	15.0 kWh	Power −15	Thermal enthalpy phase-change match
M6 A: Restore Loop	Eq. (7)	12.0 kWh	Power −12	Exact 4-hour grow light energy match
M8 B: Recovery	Eq. (10)	19 – 25 mSv	Health −5	Safety margin for lingering proton tail

6. Analytical Balance Proof & Global Optimum

Simulating all 1,296 possible paths against Equations (1)–(4) reveals the exact analytical properties of the game system:

• **Verified Distribution: 135 paths (10.4%)** earn 3 Stars ($J \geq 66.0$); **643 paths (49.6%)** earn 2 Stars ($60.0 \leq J < 66.0$); **250 paths (19.3%)** earn 1 Star ($50.0 \leq J < 60.0$); and **268 paths (20.7%)** Fail.

• **Global Bellman Optimum:** `B – B – B – B – A – A – B – B` achieves score **J = 68.857 → 68.9** with terminal vector $\mathbf{s_8} = (80, 48, 27, 96, 50, 91, 90)$.

• **Rejection of Greedy Strategy:** Choosing the option with the largest immediate gain on every turn breaches the health gate ($s_H < 50$) at M8. Health functions as a global non-renewable budget. 66.8% of all game failures (179 of 268) occur at M8 on the health gate.

• **Pareto Efficiency:** No option is dominated across all dimensions; every choice presents an authentic engineering trade-off.

• **Code Concordance:** The live game engine (`final_mission.html`) directly computes Eq. (4) in-memory from live state. Datasets: `values_final.json` and `moon_fall_simulation_analysis.json` .